Apex Systems: Response to RFP No. KML/HR/2026/014 - HR Service Delivery Platform

Submitted to Kestrel Manufacturing Ltd (fictional) | Submission date: 2026-10-06 | Fictional proposal for classroom use

1. Executive Summary

Apex Systems proposes **ApexHR Nexus**, an enterprise-grade HR service delivery platform built on a cloud-native microservices architecture. Our design prioritises integration depth, resilience and security, and is engineered to scale well beyond Kestrel's current 6,500 employees.

We commit to a contractual availability of 99.95% with active-active deployment across two Indian Azure regions (Pune and Chennai), and we hold ISO 27001:2022 and SOC 2 Type II certifications.

2. Our Understanding of the Requirement

Kestrel requires a cloud HR service delivery platform for about 6,500 employees across 4 plants and a head office: an employee self-service portal, HR case management with SLAs, a policy knowledge base, and integration with the existing SAP SuccessFactors HRIS and Microsoft Entra ID single sign-on.

We understand the key success factors to be: accurate employee data from SuccessFactors, a single front door for employee queries, measurable SLA adherence, and auditable handling of sensitive HR data.

3. Proposed Solution and Architecture

ApexHR Nexus is composed of independently deployable services (Portal, Case Engine, Knowledge, Workflow, Analytics) running on Kubernetes (AKS) behind an API gateway.

- **HRIS integration:** certified SAP SuccessFactors connector using OData v4 APIs with near real-time delta sync every 15 minutes and event-driven updates for joiners, movers and leavers.
- **Identity:** SAML 2.0 / OIDC single sign-on with Microsoft Entra ID; SCIM 2.0 user provisioning.
- **Open APIs:** 140+ documented REST APIs and webhooks for payroll, ITSM (ServiceNow) and Teams.
- **Scalability:** load tested to 50,000 concurrent users with p95 page response under 1.2 seconds.
- **Data model:** configurable case categories, dynamic forms and a rules engine without code changes.
- **Analytics:** embedded dashboards for case volumes, SLA breach risk and knowledge-article deflection.

4. Implementation Approach, Timeline and Team

We follow a four-phase approach over **18 weeks**: Discover and Design (weeks 1-4), Build and Integrate (weeks 5-11), Test and Train (weeks 12-15) and Go-live with Hypercare (weeks 16-18).

Milestone	Week	Exit criteria
Solution design sign-off	4	Approved design, integration specification
SuccessFactors and SSO integration complete	10	Integration test pass rate 98%+
User acceptance testing complete	15	No open Severity 1 or 2 defects
Go-live (all sites)	16	Cutover checklist signed

Team: engagement director, solution architect, 2 integration engineers, 2 configuration consultants, QA lead and change-management consultant. The detailed risk register will be produced during discovery.

5. Commercial Proposal

Item	Year 1 (INR)	Year 2 (INR)	Year 3 (INR)
Subscription (6,500 employees)	58,50,000	58,50,000	61,42,500
Implementation services (fixed price)	52,00,000	-	-

Item	Year 1 (INR)	Year 2 (INR)	Year 3 (INR)
Premium support and TAM	6,00,000	6,00,000	6,00,000
Total	**1,16,50,000**	**64,50,000**	**67,42,500**

Three-year total cost of ownership: **INR 2,48,42,500** excluding GST. Assumptions: prices are valid for 90 days; subscription uplift of 5% in Year 3; customer provides SuccessFactors API access and test tenants; travel billed at actuals capped at 3% of services.

6. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

- ISO 27001:2022 certified (certificate no. AX-ISMS-4471, valid to March 2028) and SOC 2 Type II report for the period April 2025 - March 2026 available under NDA.
- Encryption: AES-256 at rest with customer-managed keys in Azure Key Vault; TLS 1.3 in transit.
- India data residency; compliant with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, with consent and data-principal request workflows built in.
- Role-based and attribute-based access control; MFA enforced for all administrators.
- Immutable audit logs retained for 7 years and exportable to the customer SIEM.
- Independent VAPT twice a year by a CERT-In empanelled auditor; critical findings fixed within 7 days.

7. Support Model and Relevant Experience

Support is provided 24x7 for Priority 1 incidents (response within 30 minutes) and business hours for lower priorities, with a named Technical Account Manager.

Apex has delivered HR service delivery platforms for 9 enterprises in the last six years, including a 12,000-employee automotive components manufacturer (fictional reference: Meridian Auto Parts, HR Director available on request).